secret language he relayed to me the news of the arrest of Jonathan Pollard; I, of course, had no idea who he was and what he had done. The phone call was basically a heads-up; a person suspected of spying for Israel had been arrested around the same time that I arrived in the United States, and there was no way of knowing whether this would at some point raise a red flag, so it was important for me to be forewarned. I was not told to do anything differently or to change my daily routine; I should just lie low and not lose my cool should the doorbell ring one day and a stranger begin asking me intrusive questions. This never happened, and after a day or two we went back to being regular students.

Just as a new Israeli prime minister tends to hold his or her first meeting abroad with the president of the United States, I held my first visit abroad as director of the Mossad at the CIA headquarters in Langley, in the suburbs of Washington, D.C., in May 1989. Over the next seven years I would visit there many times. I did my best to establish a relationship based on "win-win" calculations, despite the vast differences in size, resources, and deployment between the CIA and us.

The relationship between the Mossad and the CIA has been and always will be in large part derived from the state of Israel-US relations. These relations are based not only on common interests but also on shared Judeo-Christian values. When David Ben-Gurion formulated the components of Israel's national security during the state's early days, he included the support of a world power as a necessary condition for the continued existence of the State of Israel. Throughout most of Israel's existence, the United States has, and still does, fulfill this role. The United States has been a guarantor of Israel's survival since its establishment. This guarantee has not always been de jure (official or legally binding), but even when it has been de facto (fulfilled in practice) it has carried great significance because Israel's enemies and potential enemies have understood that the United States would never allow Israel to be destroyed.

This principle was also reflected in the field of intelligence, though it had limitations. For example, the CIA and other US intelligence agencies generally did not share their intelligence with us if it was related to a country that was hostile to us but friendly with the United States.

Throughout almost the entire Cold War, there was symmetry between the two countries' political and intelligence relations. The Soviet Union was a fierce opponent of both the United States and Israel, as were all of the Arab